

Your questions, our answers

All your computer niggles and nags are dealt with here!

Can't open files

I have an Intel Core 2 Duo powered PC with 1 GB of memory and 160-GB hard drive running on Windows XP. The hard drive has four partitions – three of them are 40 GB each and the last one is 29 GB. There is a folder containing about 30 GB of data in the E drive. All files in this folder are shown properly and even Windows XP recognises them. The folder has AVI, MKV and MP3 files. When I double-click on any of these files, they don't open. I tried using VLC, but it wouldn't open them either. Sometimes, I get a message saying Access is denied. I don't want to lose the data so I don't want to format the partition.

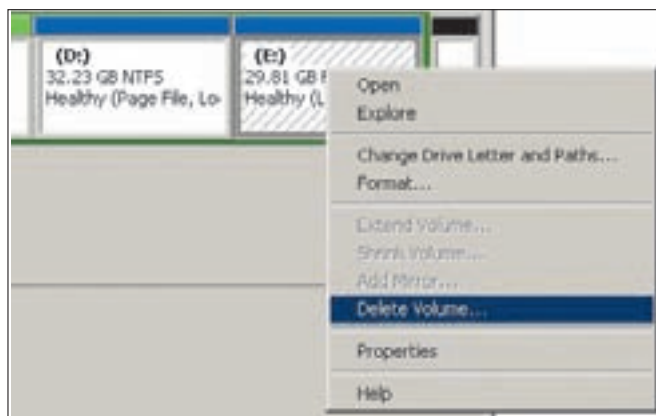
Animish Vaidya

The problem you are facing could be due to permissions for that drive or partition. If you were previously running a different operating system, the rights and permissions for a partition might still be present. You need to authenticate using the same user name and password to access the folder. Create a new user through the Control Panel with the previously used credentials and try accessing the drive. You can also change the permissions by right-clicking on a particular drive or folder and clicking on the Security tab.

Flash drive woes

I have a 2 GB Transcend pen drive. I locked it using a data locking program and gave it to one of my friends. He formatted it and now, it only shows 1 GB as usable. The pen drive shows up as empty but it contains 1 GB of data. I also tried formatting but it hasn't helped. Give me a solution for the problem.

Sourav Paramanik



Deleting the partition from a drive

If there isn't any important data on the drive, the simplest fix is to delete all the partitions on it. To do this, click on **Start > Control Panel > Administrative Tools > Computer Management**. Click on Disk Management. Right-click on the partition on the flash drive and click Delete Volume. Use similar steps to recreate a partition in the free space.

How to burn?

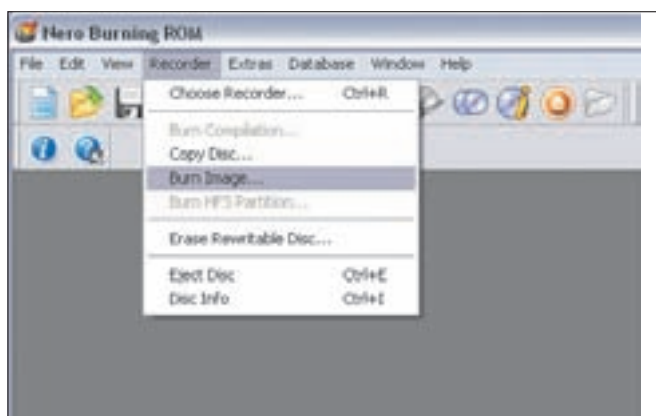
I have a lot of movies on my hard disk and I want to burn them on DVDs. Suggest me an easy-to-use burning program that can convert every video

format to the VOB format so I can play them on my DVD player.

I have images of a few operating systems. I don't know how to create a bootable disk. Kindly help me with the complete process of how to create a bootable CD/DVD so that I can install them on my system.

P. Parikshit

It's difficult to find a single program that can convert every format to VOB. You might have to use a combination of programs. Check out Media Coder (<http://mediacoder.sourceforge.net>). Convert the videos you want to AVIs using the Xvid codec. Use Nero after that or any other popular DVD



Burning a disk image using Nero

burning program to write the AVI as a video DVD.

Disk images of operating systems such as Linux distributions are bootable images. You can simply burn them to the disk. Don't burn them as a file on the disk, but as a disk image. For example, in Nero Burning ROM, click on **Recorder > Burn Image**. Choose the image file, set a speed for writing and burn the disk. To be able to boot from the CD or DVD, you'll have to set your optical drive as the primary boot drive from the BIOS.

Logon problem

I have an Intel Pentium 4 system running Windows XP SP2 with a 3-GHz processor and 1 GB of memory. I have a problem with the logon screen. When I turn on my PC, I can't find the Welcome screen. With fast user switching turned on, it automatically opens to Windows.

Bishwas Gurung

Setting a password to your current account might help. If your Windows XP runs on a single user without a set password, it might automatically boot into the desktop. Go to the Control Panel and set a password to the account. If you are using some customised version of Windows, then the autologin might be a feature of that program.

Get Help Now!

E-mail us your computing problems along with your contact details and complete system configuration to sos@thinkdigit.com, and we might answer them here! Since we get many more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!